

Week 9 : Applications

(B+C Chapter 7)

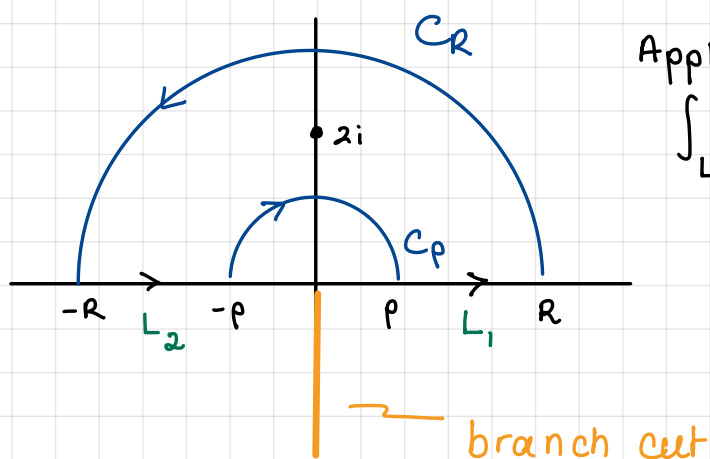
When using residues to compute integrals we may sometimes need to choose a contour to avoid a singularity or branch point.

Example $\int_0^{\infty} \frac{\ln x}{(x^2+4)^2} dx$

Consider $f(z) = \frac{\log z}{(z^2+4)^2}$ where $|z| > 0$ and $-\frac{\pi}{2} < \arg z < \frac{3\pi}{2}$.

f is analytic on the plane except a branch point at zero, a pole at $z=2i$ and a branch cut on $(0, \infty i)$.

So we consider the following simple closed contour.



Applying the Cauchy Residue theorem:

$$\int_{L_1} f(z) dz + \int_{C_R} f(z) dz + \int_{L_2} f(z) dz + \int_{C_p} f(z) dz = 2\pi i \operatorname{Res}_{z=2i} f(z).$$

— (*)

Note: $\int_{L_2} f(z) dz + \int_{L_1} f(z) dz = \int_{-R}^{-\rho} \frac{\ln|x| + i\pi}{(x^2+4)^2} dx + \int_{\rho}^R \frac{\ln|x|}{(x^2+4)^2} dx$

$$= 2 \int_{\rho}^R \frac{\ln x}{(x^2+4)^2} dx + i\pi \int_{\rho}^R \frac{1}{(x^2+4)^2} dx$$

and also $f(z) = \frac{\phi(z)}{(z-2i)^2}$ where $\phi(z) = \frac{\log z}{(z+2i)^2}$ is analytic and non-zero.

$$\Rightarrow \operatorname{Res}_{z=2i} f(z) = \phi'(2i) = \frac{d}{dz} \left(\frac{\log z}{(z+2i)^2} \right)$$

$$= \frac{(z+2i)^2 \frac{1}{z} - 2(z+2i) \log z}{(z+2i)^4} \Big|_{z=2i}$$

$$= \frac{(4i)^2 \cdot \frac{1}{2i} - 2(4i) \log(2i)}{(4i)^4}$$

$$= \frac{8i - 8i(\ln 2 + \pi/2 i)}{256}$$

$$= \frac{\pi}{64} + \frac{1}{32}(1 - \ln 2)i$$

The remaining two terms should go to zero.

$$\cdot \left| \int_{C_R} \frac{\log z}{(z^2+4)^2} dz \right| \leq \frac{\ln R + 2\pi}{|R^2-4|} \cdot \pi R = \frac{\frac{\ln R}{R} + \frac{2\pi}{R}}{1 - \frac{4}{R^2}} \rightarrow 0 \text{ as } R \rightarrow \infty.$$

$$\cdot \left| \int_{C_\rho} \frac{\log z}{(z^2+4)^2} dz \right| \leq \frac{-\ln \rho + 2\pi}{|\rho^2-4|} \cdot \pi \rho = -\rho \frac{\ln \rho + 2\pi^2 \rho}{|\rho^2-4|} \rightarrow 0 \text{ as } \rho \rightarrow 0.$$

So taking the limit as $R \rightarrow \infty$ and $\rho \rightarrow 0$ we get:

$$2 \int_0^\infty \frac{\ln x}{(x^2+4)^2} dx + i\pi \int_0^\infty \frac{1}{(x^2+4)^2} dx = 2\pi i \left(\frac{\pi}{64} + \frac{1}{32}(1 - \ln 2)i \right)$$

Taking the real part:

$$\boxed{\int_0^\infty \frac{\ln x}{(x^2+4)^2} dx = \frac{\pi}{32}(\ln 2 - 1)}$$

If we instead take imaginary parts we also get:

$$\int_0^\infty \frac{1}{(x^2+4)^2} dx = \frac{\pi}{32}.$$

Definite Integrals of Sines + Cosines

We can use similar techniques to evaluate some definite integrals.

Idea: Suppose we are interested in the integral

$$I = \int_0^{2\pi} F(\sin\theta, \cos\theta) d\theta$$

Then we can use $z = e^{i\theta}$ to write

$$\begin{aligned}\sin\theta &= \frac{1}{2i} (e^{i\theta} - e^{-i\theta}) & , \quad \cos\theta &= \frac{1}{2} (e^{i\theta} + e^{-i\theta}) \\ &= \frac{1}{2i} (z - z^{-1}) & &= \frac{1}{2} (z + z^{-1})\end{aligned}$$

and hence

$$I = \int_C F\left(\frac{1}{2i}(z - z^{-1}), \frac{1}{2}(z + z^{-1})\right) \frac{1}{iz} dz.$$

where C is the unit circle. We can then use the Cauchy Residue theorem to evaluate the integral.

Example. Compute $\int_0^{2\pi} \frac{d\theta}{1 + a \sin\theta}$ for $-1 < a < 1$ and $a \neq 0$.

Making the substitution from above.

$$\frac{1}{1 + a \cdot \frac{1}{2i}(z - z^{-1})} = \frac{\frac{2i}{a}z}{\frac{2i}{a}z + z^2 - 1}$$

$$\Rightarrow I = \int_0^{2\pi} \frac{d\theta}{1 + a \sin\theta} = \int_C \frac{\frac{2i}{a}}{z^2 + \frac{2i}{a}z - 1} dz$$

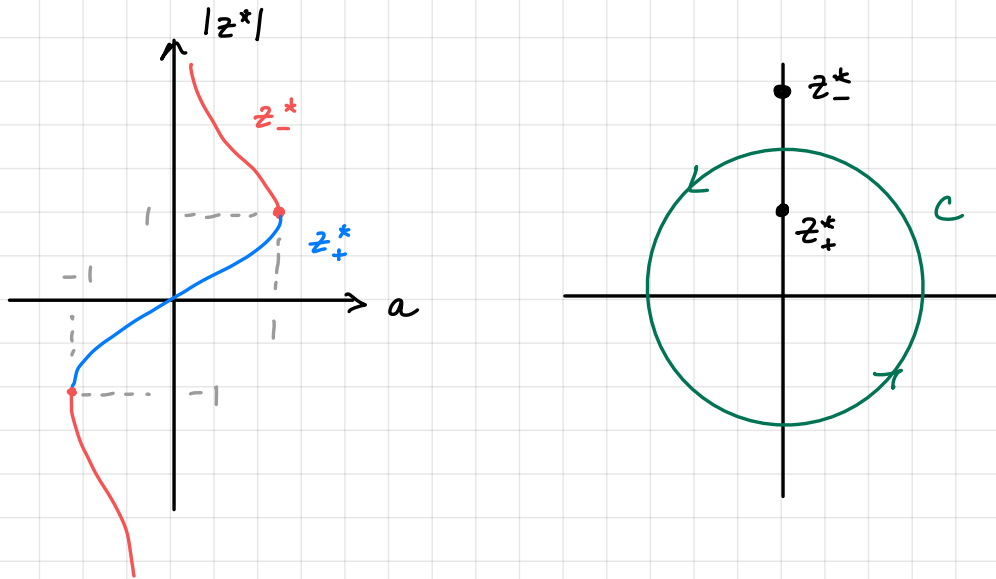
By completing the square:

$$\begin{aligned}z^2 + \frac{2i}{a}z - 1 &= z^2 + \frac{2i}{a}z - \frac{1}{a^2} + \frac{1}{a^2} - 1 \\ &= \left(z + \frac{i}{a}\right)^2 + \frac{1}{a^2} - 1\end{aligned}$$

and so singularities are found at

$$z_{\pm}^* = -\frac{i}{a} \pm \sqrt{1 - \frac{1}{a^2}} = -\frac{i}{a} \pm i \sqrt{\frac{1}{a^2} - 1} = \frac{i}{a} (-1 \pm \sqrt{1 - a^2})$$

We can determine where these points are in the complex plane by plotting $|z^*|$:



Hence,
$$I = \int_C \frac{2/a}{(z - z_+^*)(z - z_-^*)} dz = 2\pi i \operatorname{Res}_{z=z_+^*} f(z).$$

To compute the residue we note

$$f(z) = \frac{2/a}{z - z_-^*} \cdot \frac{1}{z - z_+^*} =: \frac{\phi(z)}{z - z_+^*}$$

where $\phi(z)$ is analytic and non-zero. Since the pole is simple we find

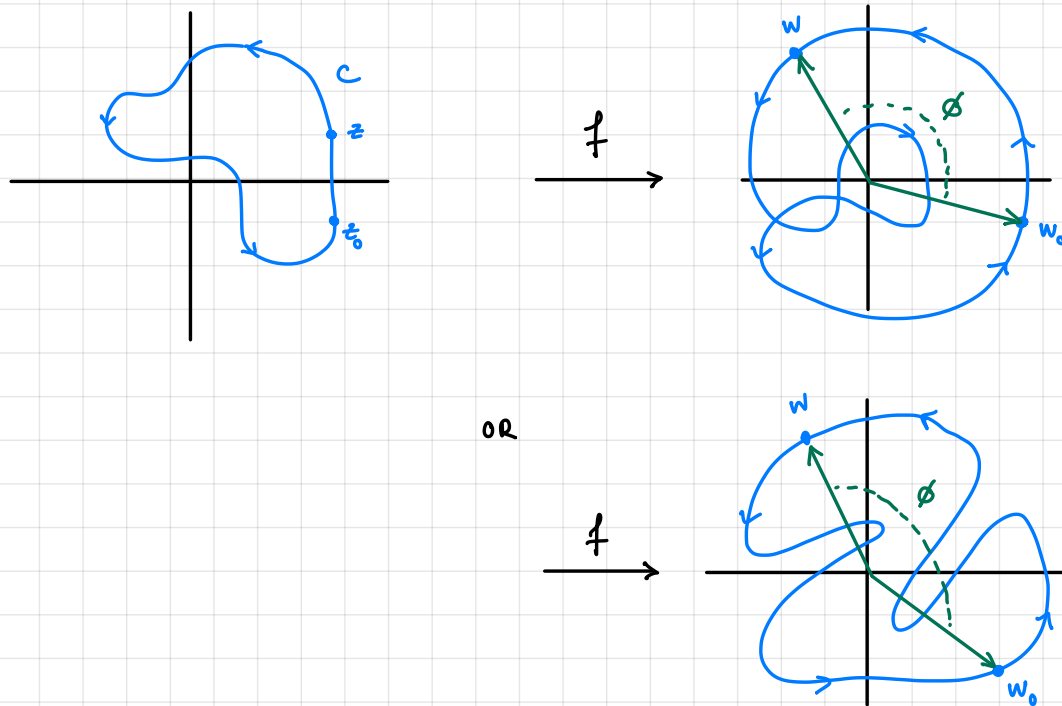
$$\begin{aligned} \operatorname{Res}_{z=z_+^*} f(z) &= \phi(z_+^*) = \frac{2/a}{z_+^* - z_-^*} = \frac{2/a}{\frac{i}{a}(-1 + \sqrt{1 - a^2}) - (-1 - \sqrt{1 - a^2})} \\ &= \frac{2}{i2\sqrt{1 - a^2}} = -i \frac{1}{\sqrt{1 - a^2}} \end{aligned}$$

$$\Rightarrow I = 2\pi i \cdot \frac{-i}{\sqrt{1 - a^2}} = \frac{2\pi}{\sqrt{1 - a^2}}$$

The Argument Principle

We can also use contour integration to detect zeros and poles of analytic functions.

Suppose f is analytic on the interior of a simple closed contour C . Then the image of C under f , Γ , is also a closed contour.



If we also assume f is non-zero on C , then Γ does not pass through 0.

Let $w = f(z)$ and $w_0 = f(z_0)$. We imagine that z is allowed to traverse the path starting from z_0 .

Then we track the angle spanned by w and w_0 . Once z returns to z_0 , w returns to w_0 and so ϕ must be a multiple of 2π .

We define this angle: $\Delta_C \arg f(z) := \phi_1 - \phi_0$

or the winding number of C and f .

It turns out the winding number is determined by the number of roots and poles of f inside C .

Thm: Let C denote a positively oriented simple closed contour and suppose

- (a) a function $f(z)$ is analytic inside C except at poles
- (b) $f(z)$ is analytic and non-zero on C
- (c) counting multiplicities, Z = number of roots of f inside C , P = number of poles of f inside C .

Then
$$\Delta_C \arg f(z) = 2\pi(Z - P).$$

Proof: We consider the function $g(z) = \frac{f'(z)}{f(z)}$ and a parameterization $z = z(t)$ of C .

Then
$$\int_C g(z) dz = \int_a^b \frac{f'(z(t))}{f(z(t))} z'(t) dt$$

But now, $f(z(t))$ is non-zero and so we can reparameterize this as a path

$$w(t) = f(z(t)) = \rho(t) e^{i\phi(t)}$$

a parameterization for Γ . Then

$$\begin{aligned} f'(z(t)) z'(t) &= \frac{d}{dt} (f(z(t))) = \frac{d}{dt} (\rho(t) e^{i\phi(t)}) \\ &= \rho'(t) e^{i\phi(t)} + i \rho(t) e^{i\phi(t)} \phi'(t) \\ \Rightarrow \int_C \frac{f'(z)}{f(z)} dz &= \int_a^b \frac{\rho'(t) e^{i\phi(t)} + i \rho(t) e^{i\phi(t)} \phi'(t)}{\rho(t) e^{i\phi(t)}} dt \\ &= \int_a^b \frac{\rho'(t)}{\rho(t)} dt + i \int_a^b \phi'(t) dt \\ &= \ln(\rho(t)) + i \phi(t) \Big|_{t=a}^b \end{aligned}$$

But we have a closed curve so $\rho(a) = \rho(b) = |w_0|$

$$\Rightarrow \int_c \frac{f'(z)}{f(z)} dz = i(\phi(b) - \phi(a)) = i \Delta_c \arg f(z).$$

On the other hand we can compute the integral using the Cauchy Residue Theorem. To do this we need to determine what the poles of g are.

Suppose f has a zero of order m at z_0 . Then

$$f(z) = (z - z_0)^m h(z) \quad \text{where } h \text{ is analytic and non-zero at } z_0.$$

$$\Rightarrow f'(z) = m(z - z_0)^{m-1} h(z) + (z - z_0)^m h'(z)$$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{f'(z)}{f(z)} = \underbrace{\frac{m}{z - z_0}}_{\text{principal}} + \underbrace{\frac{h'(z)}{h(z)}}_{\text{analytic near } z_0 \text{ as } h(z_0) \neq 0}.$$

Hence, z_0 is a simple pole of g and $\operatorname{Res}_{z=z_0} g(z) = m$.

Suppose f has a pole of order n at z_0 . Then

$$f(z) = \frac{\phi(z)}{(z - z_0)^n} \quad \text{for } \phi(z) \text{ analytic and non-zero at } z_0.$$

$$\Rightarrow f'(z) = \frac{\phi'(z)}{(z - z_0)^n} - \frac{n \phi(z)}{(z - z_0)^{n+1}}$$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{f'(z)}{f(z)} = \underbrace{\frac{\phi'(z)}{\phi(z)}}_{\text{analytic near } z_0 \text{ as } \phi(z_0) \neq 0} - \underbrace{\frac{n}{z - z_0}}_{\text{principal}}$$

Hence, again g has a simple pole and $\operatorname{Res}_{z=z_0} g(z) = -n$.

So using the Cauchy Residue Theorem:

$$-i \Delta_c \arg f(z) = \int_c \frac{f'(z)}{f(z)} dz = 2\pi i \sum_k \operatorname{Res}_{z=z_k} g(z) = 2\pi i (Z - P)$$

□

Rouché's Theorem

Thm: (Rouché)

Let C be a simple closed contour and suppose that

(a) f and g are analytic on and inside C

(b) $|f(z)| > |g(z)|$ for every point $z \in C$.

Then $f(z)$ and $f(z) + g(z)$ have the same number of zeros inside C .

Proof: First note that neither f nor $f+g$ have a zero on C as

$$|f(z)| > |g(z)| \geq 0$$

$$|f(z) + g(z)| \geq ||f(z)| - |g(z)|| > 0.$$

So using the Argument Principle we know that

$$Z_f = \frac{1}{2\pi} \Delta_C \arg f(z), \quad Z_{f+g} = \frac{1}{2\pi} \Delta_C \arg \{f(z) + g(z)\}.$$

are the number of zeros of f and $f+g$ respectively.

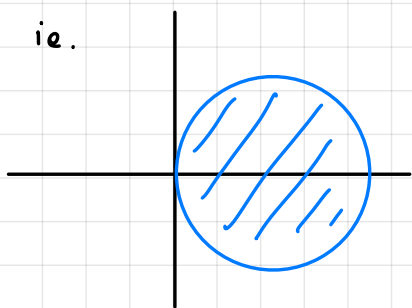
But by using additivity of the argument:

$$\begin{aligned} \Delta_C \arg \{f(z) + g(z)\} &= \Delta_C \arg \left\{ f(z) \left(1 + \frac{g(z)}{f(z)} \right) \right\} \\ &= \Delta_C \arg f(z) + \Delta_C \arg \left(1 + \frac{g(z)}{f(z)} \right) \end{aligned}$$

$$\Rightarrow Z_{f+g} = Z_f + \frac{1}{2\pi} \Delta_C \arg \left(1 + \frac{g(z)}{f(z)} \right)$$

So if we can show that $F(z) = 1 + \frac{g(z)}{f(z)}$ has winding number 0, we are done.

But note that $|F(z) - 1| = \left| \frac{g(z)}{f(z)} \right| < 1$ by assumption.



The mapping of C through F is contained in the unit ball centered at 1.

The winding number can only be zero as the contour does not surround 0.

□

Example: $z^7 - 4z^3 + z - 1 = 0$ has how many roots inside the unit circle?

Set $g(z) = z^7 + z - 1$ and $f(z) = -4z^3$

Then $\left. \begin{array}{l} |g(z)| \leq |z|^7 + |z| + 1 = 3 \\ |f(z)| = 4|z|^3 = 4 \end{array} \right\} \text{ for } z \in \text{unit circle.}$

We conclude that $f+g$ has the same number of roots inside C as f . But

$$-4z^3 = 0 \Leftrightarrow z^3 = 0 \Leftrightarrow z = 0.$$

So there is exactly 1 root inside C .

Example: From the previous integral example, we can show

$$z^2 + \frac{2i}{a}z - 1 = 0 \quad (-1 < a < 1 \text{ and } a \neq 0)$$

has a single zero inside the unit circle.

Let $f(z) = \frac{2i}{a}z$ and $g(z) = z^2 - 1$

Then $|f(z)| = \frac{2}{|a|}$ while $|g(z)| \leq |z|^2 + 1 = 2$.

Since $|a| < 1$ we can apply Rouché's Thm to see that there is a single root in the unit circle.

Inverse Laplace Transforms

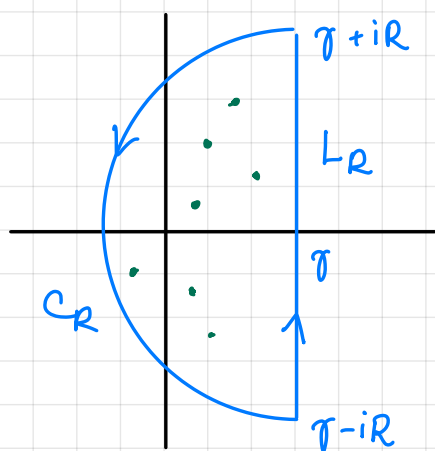
The Laplace transform of a function f is defined by

$$F(s) = \int_0^{\infty} e^{-st} f(t) dt$$

Assuming F is analytic for all s except a finite number of isolated singularities, we can find the inverse Laplace transform by the formula

$$\begin{aligned} f(t) &= \frac{1}{2\pi i} \lim_{R \rightarrow \infty} \int_{L_R} e^{st} F(s) ds \\ &= \frac{1}{2\pi i} \text{P.V.} \int_{\gamma-i\infty}^{\gamma+i\infty} e^{st} F(s) ds \end{aligned}$$

where L_R is the line segment from $\gamma - iR$ to $\gamma + iR$, and we choose $\gamma \in \mathbb{R}$ large so all the singularities of F lie to the left of the line segment.



This is called the Mellin Inverse Formula, the Bromwich integral or the Fourier-Mellin integral.

Luckily for us, this means we can compute inverse Laplace transform using the Cauchy Residue Theorem.

$$\text{Indeed by CRT: } \int_{L_R} e^{st} F(s) ds = 2\pi i \sum_{k=1}^N \text{Res}_{z=z_k} f(z) - \int_{C_R} e^{st} F(s) ds$$

where we can take the limit as $R \rightarrow \infty$ to obtain the inverse Laplace transform.

Example: Find the inverse Laplace transform of

$$F(s) = \frac{s}{(s^2 + a^2)^2} \quad (a > 0)$$

The singularities of F are $s_0 = ai$ and $\bar{s}_0 = -ai$.

However, unlike in previous examples we are interested in computing the integral of $e^{st}F(s)$ for fixed t .

We can use a nice trick to compute the sum of residues of this function.

Suppose F has a principal part

$$p(s) = \frac{b_1}{s-s_0} + \frac{b_2}{(s-s_0)^2} + \dots + \frac{b_m}{(s-s_0)^m}$$

then since $e^{st} = e^{s_0 t} e^{(s-s_0)t}$

$$= e^{s_0 t} \left(1 + (s-s_0)t + \frac{(s-s_0)^2 t^2}{2!} + \dots \right)$$

we know that the principal part of $e^{st}F(s)$ is found by from the singular terms of

$$\tilde{p}(s) = p(s)e^{st}$$

$$= \left(\frac{b_1}{s-s_0} + \frac{b_2}{(s-s_0)^2} + \dots + \frac{b_m}{(s-s_0)^m} \right) e^{s_0 t} \left(1 + (s-s_0)t + \frac{(s-s_0)^2 t^2}{2!} + \dots \right)$$

Now the residue is found as the coefficient of the $(s-s_0)^{-1}$ term.

$$\text{Hence, } \operatorname{Res}_{s=s_0} e^{st}F(s) = e^{s_0 t} \left(b_1 + \frac{b_2 t}{1!} + \frac{b_3 t^2}{2!} + \dots + \frac{b_m t^{m-1}}{(m-1)!} \right).$$

and similarly

$$\operatorname{Res}_{s=\bar{s}_0} e^{st}F(s) = e^{\bar{s}_0 t} \left(\bar{b}_1 + \frac{\bar{b}_2 t}{1!} + \frac{\bar{b}_3 t^2}{2!} + \dots + \frac{\bar{b}_m t^{m-1}}{(m-1)!} \right)$$

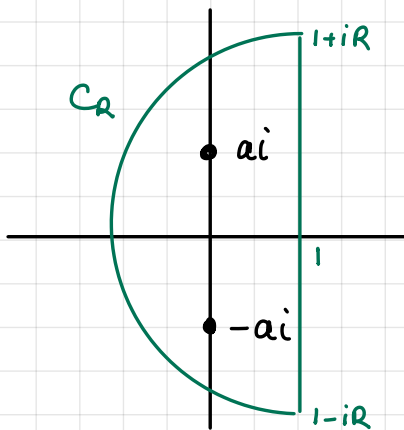
$$\Rightarrow \operatorname{Res}_{s=s_0} e^{st}F(s) + \operatorname{Res}_{s=\bar{s}_0} e^{st}F(s) = 2 \operatorname{Re} \left\{ e^{s_0 t} \left(b_1 + \frac{b_2 t}{1!} + \dots + \frac{b_m t^{m-1}}{(m-1)!} \right) \right\}.$$

In this case: $F(s) = \frac{s}{(s-ai)^s(s+ai)^2}$ so expanding at $s=ai$
we find

$$\begin{aligned} p(s) &= \frac{\phi(ai)}{(s-ai)^2} + \frac{\phi'(ai)}{(s-ai)} \quad \text{where} \quad \phi(s) = \frac{s}{(s+ai)^2} \\ &= \frac{-i/4a}{(s-ai)^2} + \frac{0}{s-ai} \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Hence, } \operatorname{Res}_{s=ai} e^{st} F(s) + \operatorname{Res}_{s=-ai} e^{st} F(s) &= 2 \operatorname{Re} \left[e^{iat} \left(-\frac{i}{4a} t \right) \right] \\ &= \frac{1}{2a} t \sin(at). \end{aligned}$$

Using this we now want to use the Cauchy Residue Thm:



$$\int_{L_R} e^{st} F(s) ds = \frac{1}{2a} t \sin(at) - \int_{C_R} e^{st} F(s) ds$$

If we can show the second integral goes to zero then we have

$$f(t) = \frac{1}{2a} t \sin(at)$$

So we want to bound the modulus.

$$\begin{aligned} \text{If } s = 1 + Re^{i\theta} \text{ then } |e^{st} F(s)| &= \left| e^{(1+Re^{i\theta})t} \frac{1+Re^{i\theta}}{((1+Re^{i\theta})^2 + a^2)^2} \right| \\ &\leq \frac{e^{t+Rt\cos\theta} (1+R)}{|R^2-1|^2 - a^2|^2} \end{aligned}$$

$$\Rightarrow \left| \int_{C_R} e^{st} F(s) ds \right| \leq \frac{e^t (1+R) \pi R}{|R^2-1|^2 - a^2|^2} \rightarrow 0 \text{ as } R \rightarrow \infty$$

since $\cos\theta \leq 0$.